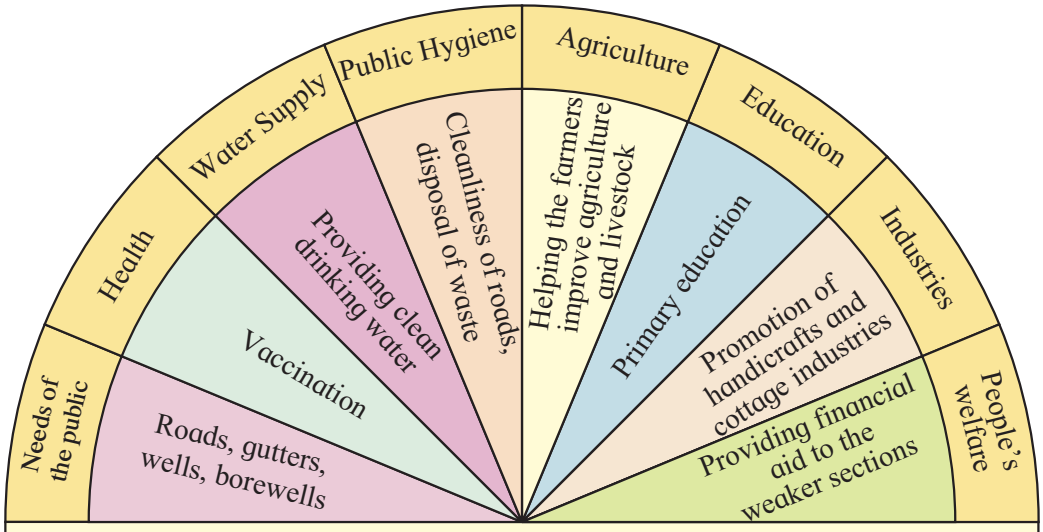


The Functions of the Panchayat Samiti

the meetings and conducting the business of the meetings. In the absence of the Chairman, the Deputy Chairman presides over the meetings.

The Functions of the Panchayat Samiti : The Panchayat Samiti prepares a plan of the schemes to be implemented in the development block. It is binding on the Panchayat Samiti to hold at least one meeting every month.

The Panchayat Samiti receives a certain amount of money from the district funds. It also receives grants from the State Government to carry out the development schemes of the development block.

3.3 Zilla Parishad

Every District has a Zilla Parishad. At present, the State of Maharashtra has 36 districts but only 34 Zilla Parishads. The reason is that Mumbai City District and Mumbai Suburban District do not have a rural population. Therefore, they do not have Zilla Parishads.

The office-bearers of the Zilla Parishad : Elections to the Zilla Parishad are held every five years. The elected representatives choose a President and a Vice-President from among themselves. The President of the Zilla Parishad presides over the meetings of the Zilla Parishad. He exercises control over business conducted during the meetings. He also controls the financial transactions of the Zilla Parishad.

He has the authority to undertake appropriate expenditure from the Zilla Parishad's funds. The Vice-President carries out these duties in the absence of the President.

Do you know ?

How does the Zilla Parishad function?

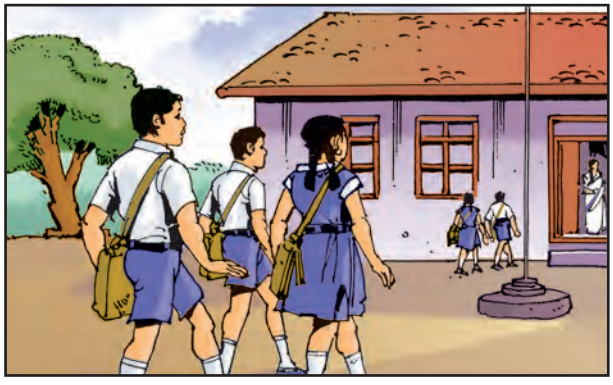
The work of the Zilla Parishad is carried out through different committees - the Finance Committee, Agriculture Committee, Education Committee, Health Committee, Water Management and Sanitation Committee, etc. The Women and Child Welfare Committee takes up issues related to problems faced by women and children.

Chief Executive Officer : The decisions taken by the Zilla Parishad are implemented by the Chief Executive Officer of the Zilla Parishad. He is appointed by the State Government.

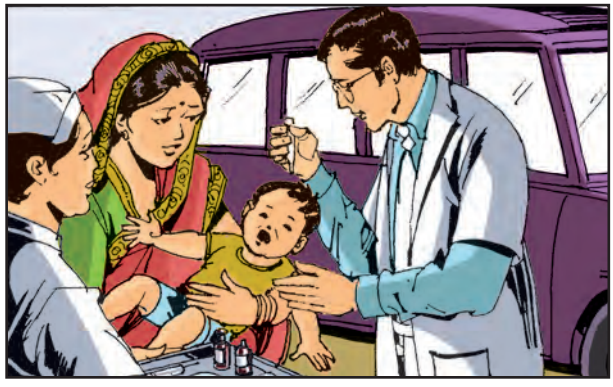
What would you do?

Imagine that you are the Chief Executive Officer of a Zilla Parishad. To which development plans would you give priority in your district?

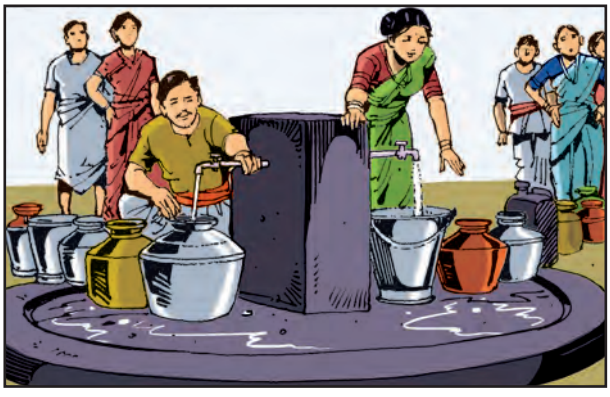
Functions of the Zilla Parishad



Education Facilities

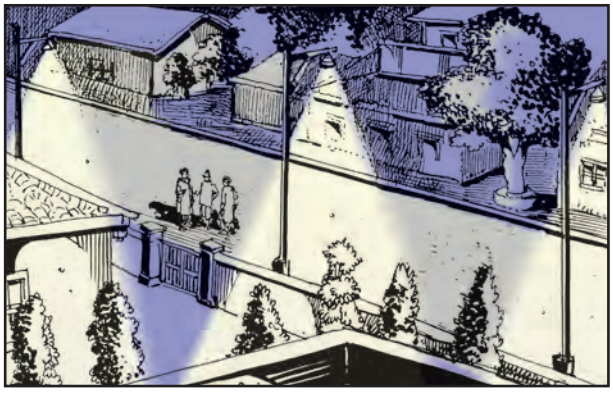


Health Facilities



Water Supply

Provision of Seeds



Electricity

Tree Plantation in the Village

What would you do?

Where would you tell Dinesh and Naina to go for the following things?

- To get their younger sibling vaccinated ..... .
- To accompany their father to get the 7/12 extract ..... .
- To learn about the use of a new manure ..... .
- To complain against contaminated water supply ..... .
- To get a birth certificate ..... .
- To get the income / caste certificate ..... .

Do you know?

Our Constitution was amended in 1992 by the 73rd and 74th Amendment Act. These amendments have granted a constitutional status to the rural and urban local government bodies. It has also given them more powers to develop their respective areas more efficiently. The number of subjects under their jurisdiction were also increased. In order to enable them to work effectively, their sources of revenue have also been increased.

Panchayati Raj System at a Glance

President ← Zilla Parishad → Chief Executive Officer

Chairman ← Panchayat Samiti → Block Development Officer

Sarpanch ← Gram Panchayat → Gram Sevak

↓ Elected Representatives

↓ Appointed by the Government

Do you know?

Who can contest elections?

In order to get elected to the Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti and Zilla Parishad, candidates must fulfil certain conditions of eligibility. For example, he/she should be a citizen of India. He/She should have completed 21 years of age. The person's name should be enrolled in the local voters list. These conditions also apply to the urban local government bodies.

Local Government Bodies – Rural

Gram Panchayat	Panchayat Samiti	Zilla Parishad
Total Membership		
Minimum 7 Maximum 17	Minimum 15 Maximum 45	Minimum 50 Maximum 75
Officer Bearers		
Sarpanch Deputy Sarpanch	Chairman Deputy Chairman	President Vice-President
Officers		
Gram Sevak	Block Development Officer	Chief Executive Officer

Exercise

1. Put a tick (✓) in the right box.

(1) The …… looks after the local administration of the village.
Gram Panchayat ☐ Panchayat Samiti ☐ Zilla Parishad ☐

(2) It is binding to hold at least …..… meetings of the Gram Sabha in each financial year.
Four ☐ Five ☐ Six ☐

(3) At present, there are …… districts in Maharashtra.
34 ☐ 35 ☐ 36 ☐

2. Make a list of the functions of the Panchayat Samiti.

3. What is your opinion?

(1) The Gram Panchayat levies various taxes.

(2) The number of Zilla Parishads is less than the total number of districts in Maharashtra.

4. Complete the Table.

My Taluka, My Panchayat Samiti.

(1) Name of the Taluka ……..

(2) The name of the Chairman of the Panchayat Samiti ……..

(3) The name of the Deputy Chairman of the Panchayat Samiti ……..

(4) The name of the Block Development Officer ……..

(5) The name of the Block Education Officer ……..

5. Write a brief note on

(1) The Sarpanch

(2) The Chief Executive Officer

Project

(1) Organize a mock Gram Sabha and enact the roles of the Sarpanch, members of the Gram Panchayat, voters, Gram Sevak.

(2) Make a chart depicting the possible structure of a *Balsansad* and display it in the class.

(3) Obtain information about the schemes run by the Zilla Parishad in your area or near your city.

* * *

4. Urban Local Government Bodies

4.1 The Nagar Panchayat

4.2 The Municipal Council

4.3 The Municipal Corporation

In the previous chapter, we have studied the nature of the local government bodies in the rural areas. In this chapter, we will learn something about the local government institutions in the urban areas. These include the Nagar Panchayat, the Municipal Council and the Municipal Corporation.

Our country has a large number of towns and cities and they are growing rapidly. Villages are growing into towns, towns into cities and cities into metropolises. The rural areas neighbouring cities are also getting transformed.

Let's discuss.

What are the main problems that cities face?

Reshma had spent a wonderful Diwali vacation with her relatives in a city. However, she began to think about some of her experiences. Think along with Reshma about these incidents and write your thoughts in two paragraphs.

- The siren of the ambulance sounded loud and clear but there was no free way on the road.
- As a result of the decision to cut the water supply, there was a great crowd at the water supply tankers.
- Efforts were being made to provide facilities to senior citizens and small children in the parks.

Facilities and Problems in Cities

1. Opportunities for industry and business
2. Expanding service sector
3. Large scale opportunities for jobs
4. Availability of facilities for entertainment, art, culture, etc.

1. Shortage of housing
2. Insufficient space
3. Traffic congestion
4. Problem of disposal of waste
5. Increasing crime
6. A large proportion of population in slums

4.1 Nagar Panchayat

The villages that are in the process of becoming towns have a Nagar Panchayat. We see some areas which are neither fully rural nor fully urban. In such areas, the local government body is the Nagar Panchayat. As with other local bodies, elections to a Nagar Panchayat are held every five years. The elected members choose a President and a Vice-President from among themselves.

All local government bodies have to carry out some essential functions. What, according to you, are the essential functions of a Nagar Panchayat?

4.2 The Municipal Council

The Municipal Council is the local government body for small cities. Elections to the Council are held every five years. The elected representatives function as Councillors. They choose a President from among themselves.

The President of the Municipal Council is the chairman of all its meetings. He controls the working of the Council and keeps a watch on the financial administration of the Council. In the absence of the President, the Vice-President looks after the work of the Council.

There are some functions that are binding on the Council. These are known as obligatory functions, for example, lighting of public streets, providing drinking water, public hygiene, sewage disposal, registration of birth/death/ marriage, etc.

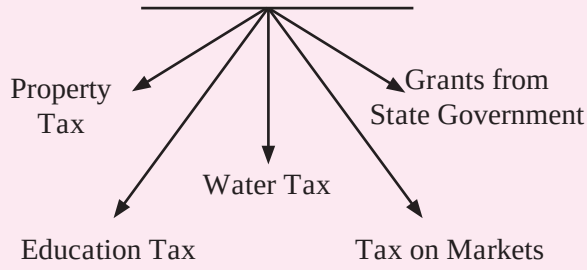
The Municipal Council also tries to provide additional facilities to the people and these functions are known as 'discretionary functions'. Planning new public roads and acquiring the necessary land, improving the condition of slums, creating public gardens and parks, providing secure shelters for cattle are some of the 'discretionary' functions of the Municipal Council.

Do you know?

For every Municipal Council, there is a Chief Officer. He implements the decisions taken by the Municipal Council. There are several officers who assist him.

* Would you like to become such an officer? If you become a Health Officer, what functions would you perform?

The sources of revenue of the Municipal Council



What would you do?

1. When you hand over your household waste to the waste pickers….
2. The road is waterlogged as the water pipe has broken.
3. You notice that unclean, impure water is being used for *pani puris*.
4. Many people are throwing plastic bags from the bridge into the river.
5. The Municipal Council's programme to clean the slum areas has been published in the newspaper, but you think that one of the planned actions is improper.

Appeal from the Municipal Council

Calling all citizens – to take the following measures to stop breeding of mosquitoes and curb the spread of dengue :

(1) Do not stack old tyres, coconut shells, empty cans or boxes on your terrace or around your house.

(2) In case of persistent fever go to a doctor without delay.

(3) Keep your surroundings clean.

* In response to the above, what would you do in your house and in the surroundings?